Chinese 245/Anthropology 241M
Chinese Culture: An Introduction
Ricks College

Instructor: Scott W. Galer
Office: SMI 475
e-mail: galers@ricks.edu
phone: 356-1521

> "…understanding a people's culture exposes their normalness without reducing their particularity…It renders them accessible: setting them in the frame of their own banalities, it dissolves their opacity" [Clifford Geertz, *The Interpretation of Cultures*, p. 14 (New York: 1973)].

It is our objective in this course to examine some of the important facets of Chinese culture, both traditional and contemporary. With a history as long and as rich as China's, we will only be able to scratch the surface of several facets of Chinese civilization, with the hope that these introductory explorations will encourage you to further your study of China, either formally or informally.

In this attempt to familiarize ourselves with some of the highlights of Chinese civilization, we will study the lives of various persons throughout Chinese history, and in doing so will also discuss some of China's philosophical and literary masterpieces. While in most cases there will be a close temporal relationship between the historical individual under study and the accompanying literature and philosophy segment, this may not always be the case. It is my hope that through this approach (biographical, philosophical and literary) we may emerge from this course with a general understanding of some of the milestones of the development of Chinese history, thought and literature, in short, Chinese *culture.*

Texts:

1. Wills, John E., Jr. *Mountain of Fame*. Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1994. (This text may be purchased in the Ricks College Bookstore.)

2. DeBary, Wm. Theodore and Irene Bloom. *Sources of Chinese Tradition, Vols. 1 and 2*. Second edition. New York: Columbia University Press, 1999. (On reserve in the library—you may purchase if you wish, but they cost around $50 per volume. Available through Amazon.com.)

3. Birch, Cyril. *Anthology of Chinese Literature, Vols. 1 and 2.* New York: Grove Press, 1965. (On reserve in the library)

4. Nienhauser, William H., Jr. *The Indiana Companion to Traditional Chinese Literature, Vols. 1 and 2*. Bloomington: Indiana University Press, 1986 and 1998. (These books are in the reference area of the library and will be useful in preparing many of your presentations, etc.)

Projects and Assignments:

Participation/Quizzes: 25%

In order to participate in class you must carefully read the assigned pages prior to class. Your preparation will be evident by the quality of your participation. The frequency of quizzes will be determined by the quality of your discussions, i.e. if there is always a lively and informed discussion of the readings, in which everyone participates, then there will likely be fewer quizzes. It goes without saying that you need to attend class regularly. More than two absences will lower your final grade by a letter. Quizzes, etc. that are missed due to absence may not be made up without prior approval by the instructor.

Student Reports: 25%

Each student will be assigned one to three reports (depending on enrollment) throughout the semester. The topics of these reports, as well as suggestions for resources, etc., will be designated by the instructor. The reports should last roughly 15 minutes and should include a few minutes for questions and discussion from the entire class. In most cases a handout should be prepared by the presenter and provided to each member of the class as well as the instructor. The content of the handout is to be determined by the presenter, however I encourage you to always include a brief bibliography related to your topic. You may be as creative as you wish with these presentations. I encourage you to explore the use of various forms of media, i.e. creating a website, using PowerPoint, etc.

Midterm Exam: 25% (Take home)

Book Review (Final) 25%

A 3-5 page book review on a book about China, Chinese culture, history, literature, thought, etc. Book must be approved by instructor. Details on this assignment will follow. We will meet together during the final exam period to discuss the books that you read. Plan ahead so that you have time to pace yourself on the reading and writing. You may need to request your book via interlibrary loan.

Grading Scale:

93–100%	A
90–92%	A-
87–89%	B+
83–86%	B
80–82%	B-
77–79%	C+
73–76%	C
70–72%	C-
67–69%	D+
63–66%	D
60–62%	D-
0–59%	F

General

- If you are in need of assistance, see the instructor for help. Please make an appointment and try to identify your specific problem before you come.
- The instructor will make every reasonable effort to accommodate students with special handicaps. Please inform him of any special needs during the first week of class.
- In response to health, death or other unforeseen circumstances, the instructor reserves the right to make changes to the syllabus during the course of the semester.

Schedule, Readings and Student Reports:

Date/Topic	*Readings and Reports*
Th 1/6 Introduction/Geography	n/a
T 1/11 Traditional vs. archaeological early history; Yu	*Mountain of Fame* (Hereafter "MOF") ch. 1 *Sources of Chinese Tradition* (Hereafter SOCT) pp. 3–23
Th 1/13 Confucius	MOF ch. 2 SOCT pp. 41–63

	Student report: "Classical Sources of Chinese Tradition" (SOCT ch. 2); prepare handout including brief bibliography of works discussed, i.e. translations of said works, secondary scholarship, etc. I suggest giving the most attention to the *Odes*.
T 1/18 Legalism and Qin Shihuang	MOF ch. 3
	SOCT pp. 206–12 on Li Si
	Student report: Qu Yuan **屈原** and the *Chuci* **楚辭** (See "The Songs of Ch'u" in Birch's *Anthology of Chinese Literature* and the *Indiana Companion*)
Th 1/20 Sima Qian and the *Shiji*	MOF ch. 4
	SOCT pp. 367–74
	Anthology of Chinese Literature (hereafter ACL) pp. 93–133 (there are several selections here—we will decide in class who reads which one and then compare our readings)
	Student report: Han *fu* **賦** (rhyme prose); use *Indiana Companion*, ACL pp. 134–153, etc. "The Wind" is one of my favorites.
T 1/25 Wang Mang	MOF ch. 5
	SOCT 363–66 (Reforms of Wang Mang)
	Student report: SOCT pp. 329–44 *Liji* (a brief introduction to the text and its contents, followed by discussion of some of the sections would be one possibility)
Th 1/27 Ban Zhao	MOF ch. 6
	SOCT pp. 821–27
	Student report: Women in Chinese literature (see me for ideas)
T 2/1 Zhuge Liang and *Xuanxue*	MOF ch. 7
	SOCT pp. 377–391 *Xuanxue*
	Student report: *The Romance of the Three Kingdoms* (see *Indiana Companion*. Also: read a section from the novel and include discussion in report. You may need to request the novel via interlibrary loan—I recommend the Moss Roberts translation—start early on this topic.)
Th 2/3 Buddhism and Hui Neng (638–713)	MOF ch. 8
	SOCT pp. 494–504
	Student report: Tao Qian **陶潛** (365–427). Use *Indiana Companion* (hereafter IC), ACL pp. 167–68, 182–88; see me for "Biography of Mr. Five Willows")

T 2/8 Empress Wu and Tang poetry	MOF ch. 9 ACL pp. 225–241 (Poetry of Li Bo and Du Fu) Student report: Tang *chuanqi* **唐傳奇** (use IC, ACL pp. 288–322)
Th 2/10 Song reforms and Su Dongpo (Su Shi)	MOF ch. 10 SOCT pp. 587–590, 609–624 Student report: Su Shi's painting and calligraphy (Look in books on Chinese art. One possibility is *Art in China* by Craig Clunas—you may need to request this one through interlibrary loan, so begin early.)
T 2/15 Neo-Confucianism and Yue Fei	MOF ch. 11 SOCT pp. 667–69, 697–714 (Song Neo-Confucianism and Zhu Xi) Student report: *Shuihu zhuan* (The Water Margin). Use IC, etc. Read some of this novel and include section in handout. You may need to request through interlibrary loan—I'm not sure if the McKay Library has a copy in its holdings.
Th 2/17 Taoism and Qiu Chuji	MOF ch. 12 SOCT pp. 77–111 (read broadly); 392–414 (decide in class who reads which sections) Student report: Contemporary Taoist cults in China and Taiwan (start researching this one early—you will likely need to use ILL)
T 2/22 Wang Yangming	MOF ch. 13 SOCT pp. 841–854 Student report: *Journey to the West* by Wu Chengen (use IC and read some of this novel—a good translation is entitled *Mondkey*, translated by Arthur Waley. You may need to request through ILL.)
Th 2/24 Zheng Chenggong	MOF ch. 14 film on Ming dynasty? Student report: A brief history of Taiwan
T 2/29 The Qianlong Emperor	MOF ch. 15 SOCT v. 2 TBA Student report: ch. 26 (?)
Th 3/2 Hong Xiuquan and the Taiping Movement	MOF ch. 16 SOCT v. 2, ch. 29 Student report: TBA

T 3/7 Liang Qichao and the Coming of the West	MOF ch. 17 SOCT v. 2, from chs. 30 and 31 (pages TBA) Student report: *Dream of the Red Chamber* (See IC; also read from the novel—you may need to request via ILL)
Th 3/9 "China in Revolution" (film)	MOF ch. 18
T 3/14 "China in Revolution" cont.	SOCT v. 2 chs. 32–34 (pages TBA)
Th 3/16 Mao Zedong	MOF ch. 19
T 3/21 "The Mao Years" (film)	SOCT v. 2 TBA

THE REMAINDER OF THE SCHEDULE IS TENTATIVE AND REMAINS OPEN TO ADJUSTMENT

Th 3/23 Names in the News	MOF ch. 20 SOCT v. 2, TBA Student report: Pick a Chinese dissident (could be one mentioned in MOF ch. 20) and give a more detailed report on their current status. Also discuss the way that human rights issues in China cause problems in Sino-US relations.
T 3/28 Christianity in China Today	SOCT v. 2, ch. 38 Student report: The LDS Church in China in the 20th century
Th 3/30 Midterm Exam (Take home)	
T 4/4 *The Gate of Heavenly Peace* (film)	SOCT v. 2, TBA
Th 4/6 *The Gate of Heavenly Peace* cont.	Read from "The Gate of Heavenly Peace" website (URL will be provided)
T 4/11 Finish "*Gate*" and discuss	Read from "The Gate of Heavenly Peace" website (URL will be provided)
Th 4/13 Contemporary Literature and Film *To Live* (film)	Readings TBA
T 4/18 *To Live* cont.	

Friday 4/21 Final Exam 3:50–5:20